CineLink: proposed project-review flow

A worked example for a practitioner to challenge

Design draft only

This is not a deployed replacement, financial advice, a funder application or evidence of funding approval.

The example is fictional. It shows today's calculation and a safer evidence-first flow we propose for discussion.

8 pages. Please change, delete or reorder any question.



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Step 1: identify the project and its rights

Proposed questions before readiness scoring

Questions for the producer

Where is the applicant registered or resident, and where will production take place?

What is the format, intended audience, language and project stage?

Who owns or controls the script and underlying rights? Are options, permissions and agreements in place?

Proposed handling

Unknown rights or missing evidence should be visible, not hidden by a high score.

Ask for confirmation before requesting documents. Do not collect a full script in an unprotected browser form.

Today's demo collects title, format and genre but does not perform these country or rights checks.

Step 2: check the team and the actual plan

Proposed questions about execution, not just labels

Questions for the producer

Which relevant credits can be evidenced, and who is responsible for production, finance and delivery?

What is the itemised budget, currency and basis for the cost estimates?

What is the schedule, and what contingencies, insurance and delivery requirements have been allowed for?

Proposed handling

Let a practitioner test whether costs and team capacity make sense together.

Do not assume an award guarantees execution, or that a first-time creator is unsuitable.

The present algorithm uses four team labels and fixed budget ceilings; it does not inspect costs or a schedule.

Step 3: establish the financing gap and market evidence

Proposed questions missing from the current score

Questions for the producer

What cash or in-kind support is already committed, and what still needs financing?

Are there documented audience tests, distributor discussions, pre-sales or commissioning agreements?

What rights, repayment obligations or revenue shares have already been promised?

Proposed handling

Distinguish signed agreements from conversations, ambitions and unsupported audience estimates.

Only consider a route against its actual conditions. A proposed global audience is not a global distribution contract.

No verified pre-sale, tax-credit entitlement or lender commitment is assumed.

Worked example: the current demo returns 65/100

Fictional project: Market Day. No real film or producer is represented

Inputs and exact calculation

Format: feature film. Genre: drama. Intended market: national. Budget: USD 100,000.

Team: first-time creator. Script: full draft. No commercial-genre bonus for drama.

Script 24 + team 5 + budget 25 + market 11 = 65/100.

Budget ratio: 100,000 / 150,000 = 0.667, below the 1.2 threshold for 25 points.

What the tool actually returns

The current label is "Investment-Ready", because 65 is above 55 and below 75.

It suggests distributor pre-sale, gap finance, brand sponsorship and regional broadcaster co-production.

Its national source list is generic. It does not prove that any of these routes would accept this project.

Stress test: where this can mislead

Exact current-rule results, not proposed changes

Missing or invalid budget

If the same example uses a zero budget, it still receives 25 budget points and totals 65.

A negative budget also falls below the upper threshold. The current scoring function has no positive-budget rejection.

The interface has a minimum-value hint, but the calculation needs explicit validation.

Unsupported market ambition

Change the example to a polished script and intended global market: 30 + 5 + 25 + 20 = 80.

The current label becomes "Institutional-Ready" even for a first-time team, without verified market access.

Should unverified information block a readiness label, trigger a caution, or remain an openly self-reported checklist?

Step 4: produce a cautious action report

Proposed output for you to critique, not a financial recommendation

What a useful report might say

What information is supplied, what is evidenced and what remains unknown.

A short list of missing documents or practical decisions needed before a financing conversation.

Possible finance routes with their eligibility conditions, official sources and last-checked dates.

Boundaries

No guarantee of funding, certification, investment readiness or commercial success.

No automatic financier contact, payment collection or submission of confidential documents.

Any incentive, legal structure or investment intermediation arrangement needs jurisdiction-specific professional advice.

Your decision on this proposed flow

Would this help a real producer, or should we change direction?

Questions for the reviewing practitioner

Which question would you remove, and which essential question is missing?

Which evidence must be checked by a person rather than scored automatically?

Should the numeric score be kept, renamed, replaced with a checklist, or removed?

Would you prefer a project-preparation tool, verified finance directory, audience tool, or another starting point?

How to respond

Corrections, a voice note or a marked-up PDF are welcome. No endorsement is expected.

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